

North Austin & The Domain: A Complete Neighborhood Guide

North Austin has emerged as the city's second major employment and lifestyle hub — anchored by Apple's campus, the Domain mixed-use district, and a rapidly growing residential community. A complete guide to who lives here, what it costs, and what buyers should know.

North Austin, anchored by Apple's sprawling campus and The Domain mixed-use district, has become the city's second major employment hub — and a fully realized residential destination in its own right.

For buyers considering Austin, understanding north Austin is no longer optional. It is home to some of the city's largest employers, strongest residential growth, and a lifestyle that competes directly with the urban core on amenities.

Why North Austin Matters: The Employment Anchor

Apple's 133-acre campus on North Burnet Road employs more than 6,000 people. Indeed, Amazon, Oracle, Google, and dozens of technology and financial services firms maintain offices in the north Austin corridor.

A household with employment in north Austin faces a very different commute decision than one working downtown. Buying in Barton Hills to commute to Apple's campus adds 30 to 45 minutes each way during peak hours. Buying in a north Austin community eliminates that friction entirely.

The Domain: Austin's Second Downtown

The Domain is a 300-acre mixed-use development with walkable retail, 50+ restaurants, a Whole Foods anchor, hotel properties, and office towers. For residents of surrounding neighborhoods, it provides an urban lifestyle experience — walkable dining, entertainment, and amenities — without downtown traffic.

Neighborhoods in North Austin's Residential Core

Great Hills, Balcones Woods, and Northwest Hills offer established single-family neighborhoods with mature tree cover and larger lot sizes. Closer to the Domain, newer townhome communities and condo developments provide walkable housing stock. Farther north — Milwood, Rattan Creek, Anderson Mill — the fabric becomes more traditionally suburban with larger lots and more square footage per dollar.

Schools in North Austin: Leander ISD and Austin ISD

Areas north of 183 toward Cedar Park and Leander fall within Leander ISD — one of the region's strongest districts, with Vandegrift and Vista Ridge High Schools among its top campuses. Areas within the 78759 and 78750 zip codes closer to the urban core typically fall within Austin ISD. Verify the specific campus assignment at the exact address before purchasing.

What Home Prices Look Like in North Austin

Single-family homes in Great Hills and Northwest Hills range from \$550,000 to \$900,000. Milwood, Rattan Creek, and Four Points offer homes in the \$450,000 to \$700,000 range. Townhomes and condos near the Domain range from \$350,000 to \$600,000. North Austin is generally 20-35% less expensive than comparable homes in the 78704 zip code.

Commute Realities from North Austin

For Domain and north Austin employers, most north Austin neighborhoods offer a 10 to 20 minute commute even at peak hours. Commuting to downtown is different: Mopac and I-35 experience significant congestion. A north Austin to downtown commute that takes 20 minutes at 10am routinely takes 40 to 50 minutes at 8am.

Who North Austin Is Right For

North Austin is most compelling for buyers whose employment is anchored in the Domain, the Arboretum, or the 183 Tech Corridor. It is also well-suited for buyers who want urban amenities at a lower price point than 78704 or Tarrytown, and who accept a more suburban residential character in

exchange.

North Austin rewards buyers who match neighborhood to actual lifestyle — not the lifestyle they imagine having someday.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Is The Domain a good area to buy a home in Austin?

The Domain area is a strong choice for buyers whose employment is in north Austin and who value walkable access to dining, retail, and entertainment. Townhomes and condos near the Domain range from \$350,000 to \$600,000. The area benefits from proximity to Apple, Indeed, and a growing employer cluster — making it an employment-convenient alternative to the urban core for technology and professional-sector workers.

Q: What neighborhoods are in north Austin?

North Austin's residential core includes Great Hills, Northwest Hills, Balcones Woods, Milwood, Rattan Creek, Anderson Mill, Four Points, and Jollyville — plus townhome and condo developments near the Domain and Arboretum. Cedar Park and Leander are functionally part of the north Austin residential market and fall within Leander ISD.

Q: How do home prices in north Austin compare to central Austin?

North Austin is generally 20-35% less expensive than comparable homes in central Austin neighborhoods like Barton Hills, Zilker, or Bouldin Creek. Single-family homes range from \$450,000 to \$900,000 depending on neighborhood. That represents meaningful value relative to the 78704 zip code, where median prices exceed \$850,000.

Q: What school district is north Austin in?

School district assignment varies significantly by address. Areas north of 183 toward Cedar Park and Leander fall within Leander ISD — one of the region's strongest districts. Areas within 78759 and 78750 closer to the urban core typically fall within Austin ISD. Verify the specific campus assignment at the exact address before purchasing.

Q: Is north Austin good for commuting to downtown?

For downtown employment, north Austin presents real trade-offs. Mopac and I-35 experience significant peak-hour congestion — a 20-minute commute at 10am can reach 40 to 50 minutes at 8am. MetroRail's Red Line offers an alternative for compatible schedules. North Austin commutes

are most favorable when employment is in the Domain corridor or along the 183 Tech Corridor rather than downtown proper.

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